

We Are Heirs of God

Let us review where we left off and take this a step further. For the last several Sunday mornings, I have wanted to back up into the covenant with Abraham, the promise God made to him, and begin breaking that down. Every time, there has still been enough left in this area that He wanted me to come back and clarify a little more.

Teaching is when you transfer what you understand into somebody else, and not a moment before.

We are dealing with the difference between covenant and sonship. Today we will look at the covenant a little closer, or the change of covenant, as Hebrews describes it.

Galatians 3:26-29 says:

"For ye are all the children of God by faith in Christ Jesus.
For as many of you as have been baptized into Christ have put on Christ.
There is neither Jew nor Greek,
there is neither bond nor free,
there is neither male nor female:
for ye are all one in Christ Jesus.
And if ye be Christ's, then are ye Abraham's seed,
and heirs according to the promise."

We were baptized into His death so we could be raised in the likeness of His resurrection. My old man was crucified with Him, and the body of sin was destroyed. So the likeness of His resurrection is what my spirit came forward in.

If you are Christ's, then you are Abraham's seed and heirs according to the promise. That is past tense. You have inherited.

Galatians 4:1 says:

"Now I say, That the heir,
as long as he is a child,
differeth nothing from a servant,
though he be lord of all."

As I told you, I had passed through this word "servant" many times. One day God moved and said, "That is the word for slave." I went to the Greek, and sure enough, it meant slave.

The translators did not quite know what to do with calling Old Testament people who held the promise "slaves." Israel truly served in the house of God, so "servant" was easier. But Paul is saying something stronger.

All Gentile nations and the Jewish nation stood to inherit, but because Judaizers in Galatia were trying to bring Gentiles back under the law, Paul uses the Jew who stood to inherit the promise as the example of why they should not go back.

The Jew was called to work in God's house and stood to inherit. Yet as long as he was a child, he differed nothing from the slave to sin, though he was lord of all. He was spiritually dead like the slave, even while holding the promise in his hand.

Jesus said:

"The servant abideth not in the house for ever:
but the Son abideth ever.
If the Son therefore shall make you free,
ye shall be free indeed."

The promise was to sonship. It was about being born again.

Galatians 4:2-5 says the heir:

"Is under tutors and governors until the time appointed of the father.
Even so we, when we were children,
were in bondage under the elements of the world:
But when the fulness of the time was come,
God sent forth his Son,
made of a woman,
made under the law,
to redeem them that were under the law,
that we might receive the adoption of sons."

Jesus was made under the law, so He was under obligation to fulfill the law. He did. After He fulfilled it, He became the curse of the law, because cursed is everyone who hangs on a tree.

He was the only Man qualified to fulfill the law. The law did not free anyone from sin. By the law was the knowledge of sin. Galatians says that as many as were under the law were under the curse of the law, because they could not keep it.

Jesus was born under the law and could fulfill it because He was the first Man since Adam to be born spiritually alive. He had a nature that could keep the righteousness of the law. When the law said, "Thou shalt not covet," He did not covet. When it said, "No other gods," He kept it.

In Him was life, and the life was the light of men. The whole human race was spiritually dead, and suddenly one Man was born with life in Him. One candle was burning while every other candle was out.

Every other person born under the law was under its curse, because cursed is everyone who does not continue in all things written in the law. Each failure required another sacrifice. But you could not keep rolling sacrifices forward forever, and you could not keep men locked in Abraham's bosom forever waiting to be set free.

So the first Man qualified to fulfill the law came. After He fulfilled it, He became the curse of the law for every Jew who could not fulfill it. He died under that penalty and freed the Jew for sonship.

God declared both Jew and Gentile under sin so all our transgressions could be laid upon one Man, Jesus.

Galatians 4:5-6 says:

"To redeem them that were under the law,
that we might receive the adoption of sons.
And because ye are sons,
God hath sent forth the Spirit of his Son into your hearts,
crying, Abba, Father."

This says the same thing Romans 8 says:

"Ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear;
but ye have received the Spirit of adoption,
whereby we cry, Abba, Father."

The spirit of bondage again to fear was the spirit Adam gave us through spiritual death. The Jew received the commandments of righteousness and tried to keep them, but because he had a nature that could not keep them, the law brought him into bondage and fear.

First Corinthians 2 says it another way when speaking to those coming out of paganism:

"We have received, not the spirit of the world,
but the spirit which is of God;
that we might know the things that are freely given to us of God."

Romans 8 is speaking to the Jewish sector in Rome, so Paul says, "You have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear."

The Spirit of adoption is not primarily the baptism of the Holy Ghost. It is not saying that the Holy Spirit came and made adoption possible in that sense. The Spirit of adoption is the new nature you received when you were born again. The devil used to be your father because you had a sin nature and could serve no one but him. Jesus told the Jews, "You are of your father the devil."

When you received the Spirit of adoption, the same life that brought Jesus from death to life activated the law of the Spirit of life in you. The same quickening that took place in His spirit took place in yours. Out of that born-again spirit, you can now cry, "Abba, Father."

Your spirit is like the humanity of Christ, quickened from death to life.

Galatians says:

"Because ye are sons,
God hath sent forth the Spirit of his Son into your hearts,
crying, Abba, Father."

Because you are sons, God did this to you. He sent forth the Spirit of His Son.

I do not have Jesus' own human spirit. In His humanity, Jesus has a human spirit. He is God the second Person, and He is also humanity. His human spirit is the one God quickened from death to life.

I was resurrected like He was. I do not have His spirit any more than I had Adam's own spirit. But I inherited spiritual death from Adam, so the same death that was in Adam's spirit was in my spirit.

Now I have inherited the Spirit of Christ. That means the same life that was in His human spirit is now in my human spirit, but I have my own spirit that went from death to life.

As the Father has life within Himself, He gave to the Son to have life within Himself. The Son gave me to have life within myself. This took place in my human spirit.

That is what the Holy Ghost uses to make a champion out of me. He takes who Christ has made me in my new nature and brings it forward from glory to glory.

I used to think He was bringing my flesh forward from glory to glory. Your flesh is going to get shock treatment at the trumpet, when it goes from corruptible to incorruptible. Flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God, so that is not the part He is perfecting now.

The part going from glory to glory is the new creation, the new nature. Every time that new nature comes forward a degree, the flesh loses a degree.

When spiritual death reigned, it took men far into death. When you were spiritually dead, you had the capacity for great evil depending on whose hands you were in. History has proved that people can be trained into terrible things.

In the old nature, the only chance you had was for your mother or father to beat some kind of synthetic conscience into you under law. The only way to control a spiritually dead man is with law. The penalty has to be worse than the crime, because law was made for the lawless.

Sometimes a good mother has had that synthetic conscience built into her, and she is good to her children even though she does not want anything to do with God.

But you know when you are born again because you get a conscience toward God. That is the difference.

I have been born again. I do not mind telling you I am excited about it. The more I find out about this, the more excited I get.

Galatians 4:7-9 says:

"Wherefore thou art no more a servant,
but a son;
and if a son, then an heir of God through Christ.
Howbeit then, when ye knew not God,
ye did service unto them which by nature are no gods.
But now, after that ye have known God,
or rather are known of God,
how turn ye again to the weak and beggarly elements,
whereunto ye desire again to be in bondage?"

Paul says, "Now that you have known God," then corrects himself: "or rather are known of God."

It took me a while to understand why. They did not father God. God fathered them. The emphasis is not merely that you know God. The emphasis is that you are known of God.

The Father has recognized you as His son and written you into His will. Why would you step out of your inheritance and go back to live like a slave?

When I did not understand the change of covenant, I taught deeply on covenant. As a faith man, I was trained to say, "I am a covenant man." But now Galatians says that if I am Christ's, I am Abraham's seed and have inherited according to the promise.

God cut a covenant with Abraham and promised sonship. Abraham stood before the One who quickens the dead. Because Abraham believed God could quicken the dead, God could put righteousness to his account. Abraham could resist the devil as though he had already been born again, because that righteousness would be paid in full at the resurrection of Christ.

That covenant with Abraham was for sonship. Now that I am Abraham's seed and that covenant has been fulfilled, I have become a son. Therefore, I am an heir according to His promise.

I do not approach God quoting my covenant now. I approach Him as Father. I say, "It is me, Father. You made me a joint heir with Christ. You made me Your son, and I thank You for what You are doing for me."

I cannot tell you what this has done for my worship and my standing.

God startled me with this revelation through adoption.

We adopted Daniel and Tawny. Tawny came from the Philippines, and Daniel came through an adoption situation. Daniel and Tawny are adopted; David, Steve, and Bill are not.

Because Tawny is Filipino, people eventually noticed she looked different. We had told her she was adopted from the time she could talk. When she wanted to understand it, we explained it to her. She asked, "When kids ask me if I am adopted, what do I say?"

I said, "Tell them you used to be."

The adoption was completed. She became a full-fledged daughter in our family, with full inheritance. She is no longer outside trying to prove she belongs. The covenant papers were fulfilled.

Romans 8 says:

"Ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear;
but ye have received the Spirit of adoption,
whereby we cry, Abba, Father.
The Spirit itself beareth witness with our spirit,
that we are the children of God:
and if children, then heirs;
heirs of God, and joint-heirs with Christ."

The first thing God gave us as heirs was a born-again spirit. The next thing He will give us is a glorified body. Romans 8:23 says the adoption process will be completed at the glorification of the body.

That simply means that, just as the first Adam gave you spirit, soul, and body, you will completely manifest as a son of God when your body changes ownership from the first Adam to the last Adam. Right now you are already an heir of God and a joint heir with Jesus Christ. At the glorified body, sonship will be complete in manifestation.

When our adoption of Daniel and Tawny was not yet final, there was a waiting period. Until it was completed, someone else still had a legal claim. That waiting period felt long because, though they were not born in the womb, they were born in the heart.

When the adoption was finished, ownership changed. No one else could take them.

When you were born again, you became an heir to everything. God's Spirit bears witness with your spirit that you are His son, even while you are still wearing this body. He has promised the manifestation of your sonship when your body changes ownership from the first Adam to the last Adam at the trumpet.

Right now, in the middle of trouble and flesh, His Spirit is bearing witness with mine that it is too late for sin to claim me. I have already become a son of God. The earnest of my inheritance has come to help me wait for my glorified body. He is my guarantee that I will receive that body.

Sin cannot have me. The devil cannot have me. Poverty cannot have me. I stand to inherit everything because I am a son.

Jesus is my oldest Brother in the body of Christ. He that sanctifies and they who are sanctified are all of one. For this reason, He is not ashamed to call me brother. He was the firstborn of many brethren, the firstborn from the dead.

There were physical resurrections before Him, but He was the firstborn since Adam brought spiritual death into the human race. He was the firstborn spiritually alive out of death, my oldest living Brother.

He was the only One not adopted. We were adopted because we were slaves to sin and had another master. Jesus never served sin. He was made to be sin, but He was not adopted. He had no other slave master. I was a servant to sin, so I had to be adopted.

Think of an adopted child coming into the room beside a natural-born child. If the natural-born son asks for help with his inheritance, he knows he can ask as a son.

But suppose the adopted child comes in, pulls out the adoption contract, and starts quoting articles to convince the father to act like his father. That would be absurd. The adoption has already been fulfilled. The child belongs.

I am a son, and I receive according to sonship. I am God's son. Every day the Holy Spirit explains my inheritance to me, for He is the earnest of my inheritance. He is the power resident in me of God's sincerity, seeing to it that nothing has the power to stop me from inheriting.

When we say the covenant has been fulfilled, many people's minds run to Hebrews:

"This is the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel..."

So they ask, "If He established a new covenant, is that not the one we are under?"

Hebrews 9:15 says:

"And for this cause he is the mediator of the new testament,
that by means of death,
for the redemption of the transgressions that were under the first testament,
they which are called might receive the promise of eternal inheritance."

Was there one First Testament or two? God entered covenant with Abraham, and then the law was added. Added to what? Added to the promise. Added to the first covenant.

Galatians asks:

"Wherefore then serveth the law?"

It was added because of transgressions until the Seed should come to whom the promise was made.

There was one Old Testament and one New Testament. The covenant administered through Moses was added to the first. Jesus rose from the dead and became the administrator of the last will and testament, the will by which I received sonship. He inherited me. I was adopted into His family. He is my oldest living Brother, my Lord, and my Creator.

Hebrews 8:10 says:

"For this is the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel after those days, saith the Lord;
I will put my laws into their mind,
and write them in their hearts:
and I will be to them a God,
and they shall be to me a people."

This covenant God cut with Abraham for the Seed, which is Christ, resulted in adoption. It resulted in sonship.

Hebrews continues:

"And they shall not teach every man his neighbour,
and every man his brother, saying, Know the Lord:
for all shall know me,
from the least to the greatest."

The old way required external commandments and ordinances teaching men to know God. But now the commandments are written in your heart and mind through your new nature. You can know God from the least to the greatest because the covenant resulted in sonship.

Hebrews 10:16-17 says the same thing:

"This is the covenant that I will make with them after those days, saith the Lord,
I will put my laws into their hearts,
and in their minds will I write them;
And their sins and iniquities will I remember no more."

The covenant resulted in sonship. I was born again, received the nature of God, and became His son. No more does a man have to teach another man to know God externally through ordinances, sacrifices, holidays, feast days, holy days, and Sabbath days. Those were shadows and schoolmasters.

We still have teachers, instructors, and pastors in the body of Christ. But no man can give you the part that came when you were born again, received His nature, and your sins and iniquities were remembered no more.

Romans 8:1-2 says:

"There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus,
who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.
For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus
hath made me free from the law of sin and death."

In Romans 8:1, the word "spirit" should be understood as little "s." Paul is not first talking about the Holy Ghost there. He is talking about your human spirit made alive in the new birth.

There is no more condemning sentence under the judicial system of the law for those in Christ Jesus, who walk not after the unregenerated nature but after the born-again nature placed in their spirit.

The law governing the spirit of life in Christ Jesus, the same quickening that took place in Jesus, has made you free from the law of sin and death.

You do not answer to the Ten Commandments as an external law anymore. That does not mean, as the Jew objected, that we should sin because we are delivered from the law. No. The commandments are now written into your heart and mind through the new nature. You finally have a nature as a son of God that can know Him and keep His ways.

You are not judged by the external law anymore. You are judged by what you do with the new nature inside you. You answer to that new nature because it set you free from the dominion of sin.

I do not have to treat you ugly. I do not have to sin. Sin and its friends have lost dominion.

I am His son, and He is the Father of my spirit. Therefore, He chastens me as a Father.